inconsistent. And, bearing in mind that, for the *Nyaya* school, universals are simple and have many instances:

> Whatever occurs in many instances must be complex.
> A universal is held to occur in many instances.
> It must be complex.

Further reading: Kajiyama 1998; Matilal 1986 and 2002b

Pratitya-samutpada (interdependent origination): the basic Buddhist theory that sees causality as nothing more than one thing's always following another in our experience. Events occur successively but there are no real causal relations or forces over and above what happens. What we interpret as cause and effect cannot be joined by a real relation that is a further factor since cause and effect occur at different times. Dependent origination is also the rejection of the view that there are types of individual entities with innate and specific causal powers: acorns don't contain tiny oak trees in a state of potentiality. But it also denies that things happen randomly, which would make nonsense of moral responsibility. Anything recognised as an entity has come into being in dependence on a complex of conditions. Buddhists deny that there are any singular persisting entities that produce others. Rather, reality consists of cooperating moments in fields of energies that are held together by a sort of magnetism. The latter power imposes temporary continuity on a stream of events. Individual people are streams of such essentially temporary physical and mental factors. The theory of conditioned origination is an attempt to account for our experience of organisation and repeatability. It applies to the physical and psychological realms and guarantees that actions will produce consequences appropriate to their moral quality.